

Matthew 11:28-30 MSG - "Are you tired? Worn out? Burned out on religion? Come to me. Get away with me and you'll recover your life. I'll show you how to take a real rest. Walk with me and work with me—watch how I do it. Learn the unforced rhythms of grace. I won't lay anything heavy or ill-fitting on you. Keep company with me and you'll learn to live freely and lightly."

If you've battled with substance abuse, anxiety, depression, PTSD or a number of other things that have weighted you down, chances are you've heard the saying, "admitting you have a problem is the first step in recovery." which is a very true and accurate statement.

The journey to living the life of an overcomer requires intentional steps and a focus on and having a heart for Christ.

If denial is the face of addiction/weights, it's easy to see how it can prevent many from receiving proper care. Breaking through self-deception is incredibly difficult but it is the most powerful first step. It allows the person that is facing the struggle, to ask one critical question: Am I living the life that Christ wants me to live?

WHY IS ADMITTING A PROBLEM, SO IMPORTANT?

Admitting you have a problem is the first step, but why? Many specialists suggest that this step indicates the person struggling is aware or becoming aware of their problematic behaviors and how those behaviors contribute to a larger health concern.

Admitting there is a problem creates a healthy mindset to begin working on the many difficult components of their weights, which were previously avoided or otherwise ignored. Admitting there is a need for a change is certainly not easy. For this reason, talk therapy and other treatment

modalities aim to support a person as they discover the truths of their struggle/weight/habits.

Asking the following questions may help in identifying substance abuse issues:

- Does my struggle interfere with healthy habits like spending time with my family, reading my Bible, praying or even just eating or sleeping well?
- Does my struggle cause me to miss important obligations that surround work, family, or personal commitments?
- Do I fall back into my struggle to help relieve stress and anxiety?
- Are my tolerance levels of dealing with people lower when faced with a situation?
- Do I hide my struggle from my loved ones?

How Do You Complete Step 1?

- Accept that something is wrong in your life and that you no longer have control. You must accept complete defeat before building a new life.
- Embrace the truth and want to make an honest change.
- Understand that recovery can't be done alone, and acknowledge that you need help.
- Abandon pride and seek humility: Once you admit your problems and flaws, you will find modesty and humbleness. You can't admit and embrace powerlessness if you're still holding on to your pride.
- Powerlessness means you're weak: Admitting powerlessness is a crucial step on the pathway to independence and strength. It requires honesty and courage to accept that your struggle has taken over your life.

2 Corinthians 12:9-10 NIV - But he said to me, "My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness." Therefore I will boast all the more gladly about my weaknesses, so that Christ's power may rest on me. That is why, for Christ's sake, I delight in weaknesses, in insults, in hardships, in persecutions, in difficulties. For when I am weak, then I am strong.

Powerlessness. I never really liked the feel of that word. I mean, who wants to feel powerless?

But when it comes to Step 1, I've come to know the POWER in it.

Yes, Step 1 was tough for me at first because I did not want to think that my addiction, attitude, and actions caused my life to become unmanageable. To me, that felt a lot like defeat.

But I had hit my rock bottom due to a tidal wave of emotions that sunk my ship. My life was a mess, and I had no idea how to contend with the internal rubble. So, finally, after about a million tears, I humbled myself. I became vulnerable. I realized that I was really powerless over addiction and my emotional life was out of control.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w_FnZpFjpTc